INDIA, CHINA, MAJOR POWERS AND RESILIENT SUPPLY CHAINS

THREE STRUCTURALLY DIFFERENT MAJOR-POWER → POLICY-TERM DISCIPLINE → INDIA-UNITED STATES TECHNOLOGY TIMELINE → DEFENCE ARCHITECTURE LADDER → RUSSIA TRACK EVIDENCE CARD → INDIA-CHINA PROCESS ARCHITECTURE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◆ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g5 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00 — THREE STRUCTURALLY DIFFERENT MAJOR-POWER TIES

THREE STRUCTURALLY DIFFERENT MAJOR-POWER TIES · INTERDEPENDENCE PLUS MISTRUST; LARGEST TRADE PARTNER IN THE BOOK-PERIOD · UNITED STATES · TECHNOLOGY-LED TACTICAL CONVERGENCE; ENABLING AGREEMENTS AND FRAMEWORKS; HIGH-TECHNOLOGY EXPORT · DEFENCE-ENERGY COMPLEMENTARITY; ENERGY-DEFICIENT MEETS ENERGY-SURPLUS · HIGH-TECHNOLOGY EQUIPMENT UNAVAILABLE FROM ELSEWHERE · A THREE-TRACK HEDGE, NEVER A BINARY CHINA-VERSUS-WEST ALIGNMENT · MUST REMEMBER

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
CHINA → interdependence plus mistrust; largest trade partner in the book-period assessment; unresolved boundary dispute drives the strategic reading	RUSSIA → defence-energy complementarity; energy-deficient meets energy-surplus	RULE → a three-track hedge, never a binary China-versus-West alignment
UNITED STATES → technology-led tactical convergence; enabling agreements and frameworks; high-technology export restrictions persist	high-technology equipment unavailable from elsewhere	MUST REMEMBER: India's relations with China and other major powers combine border...

CORE CLAIM

- CHINA → interdependence plus mistrust; largest trade partner in the book-period assessment; unresolved boundary dispute drives the strategic reading
- UNITED STATES → technology-led tactical convergence; enabling agreements and frameworks; high-technology export restrictions persist

MECHANISM

- RUSSIA → defence-energy complementarity; energy-deficient meets energy-surplus
- high-technology equipment unavailable from elsewhere

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- RULE → a three-track hedge, never a binary China-versus-West alignment
- MUST REMEMBER: India's relations with China and other major powers combine border...

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → a three-track hedge, never a binary China-versus-West alignment.

01

STAGE 01 — POLICY-TERM DISCIPLINE

POLICY-TERM DISCIPLINE · REDUCE OVERCONCENTRATION WHILE SUSTAINING ENGAGEMENT; INDIA'S POSTURE · SEVER ENGAGEMENT ALTOGETHER; EXPRESSLY NOT INDIA'S POSTURE · DIVERT CRITICAL SUPPLY CHAINS TOWARD TRUSTED PARTNERS, NOT COST · THE INCORRECT READING; THE CORRECT ONE IS DIVERSIFICATION OF

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
DE-RISKING → reduce overconcentration while sustaining engagement; India's posture	FRIEND-SHORING → divert critical supply chains toward trusted partners, not cost alone	DE-RISKING → reduce overconcentration while sustaining engagement; India's posture
DECOUPLING → sever engagement altogether; expressly not India's posture	REPLACEMENT → the incorrect reading; the correct one is diversification of dependence	DECOUPLING → sever engagement altogether; expressly not India's posture

CORE CLAIM

- DE-RISKING → reduce overconcentration while sustaining engagement; India's posture
- DECOUPLING → sever engagement altogether; expressly not India's posture

MECHANISM

- FRIEND-SHORING → divert critical supply chains toward trusted partners, not cost alone
- REPLACEMENT → the incorrect reading; the correct one is diversification of dependence

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- DE-RISKING → reduce overconcentration while sustaining engagement; India's posture
- DECOUPLING → sever engagement altogether; expressly not India's posture

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: REPLACEMENT → the incorrect reading; the correct one is diversification of dependence.

02

STAGE 02 — INDIA-UNITED STATES TECHNOLOGY TIMELINE

INDIA-UNITED STATES TECHNOLOGY TIMELINE · MAY 2022 · INITIATIVE ON CRITICAL AND EMERGING TECHNOLOGY ANNOUNCED · 31 JANUARY 2023 · INAUGURAL NATIONAL SECURITY ADVISER-LEVEL MEETING · 17 JUNE 2024 · SECOND NATIONAL SECURITY ADVISER-LEVEL REVIEW · 21 SEPTEMBER 2024

MAY 2022 — initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology announced → 31 JANUARY 2023 — inaugural National Security Adviser-level meeting → 17 JUNE 2024 — second National Security Adviser-level review → 21 SEPTEMBER 2024 — clean-energy supply-chain commitments announced → 13 FEBRUARY 2025 — TRUST and COMPACT announced with Mission 500 and trade talks

CORE CLAIM

- MAY 2022 → initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology announced
- 31 JANUARY 2023 → inaugural National Security Adviser-level meeting

MECHANISM

- 17 JUNE 2024 → second National Security Adviser-level review
- 21 SEPTEMBER 2024 → clean-energy supply-chain commitments announced

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- 13 FEBRUARY 2025 → TRUST and COMPACT announced with Mission 500 and trade talks
- STATUS → cooperation initiatives and branding; no documented legal succession

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: STATUS → cooperation initiatives and branding; no documented legal succession.

03

STAGE 03 — DEFENCE ARCHITECTURE LADDER

DEFENCE ARCHITECTURE LADDER · INDIA DESIGNATED A MAJOR DEFENCE PARTNER BY THE UNITED · LEMOA 2016 · RECIPROCAL LOGISTICS SUPPORT · COMCASA 2018 · SECURE COMMUNICATIONS · BECA 2020 · EXCHANGE OF GEOSPATIAL INFORMATION

2016 → India designated a Major Defence Partner by the United States

LEMOA 2016 — reciprocal logistics support → COMCASA 2018 — secure communications → BECA 2020 — exchange of geospatial information

CORE CLAIM

- 2016 → India designated a Major Defence Partner by the United States
- LEMOA 2016 → reciprocal logistics support

MECHANISM

- COMCASA 2018 → secure communications
- BECA 2020 → exchange of geospatial information

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- 31 OCTOBER 2025 → ten-year Framework for the US-India Major Defense Partnership
- LIMIT → enabling agreements and a framework; no collective defence, no basing right

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → enabling agreements and a framework; no collective defence, no basing right.

04

STAGE 04 — RUSSIA TRACK EVIDENCE CARD

RUSSIA TRACK EVIDENCE CARD · INDIA ENERGY-DEFICIENT, RUSSIA ENERGY-SURPLUS · UNIQUE SUPPLY · HIGH-TECHNOLOGY EQUIPMENT INCLUDING NUCLEAR-POWERED SUBMARINES · INSTALLED BASE · SU-30MKI LICENSED PRODUCTION; BRAHMOS JOINT VENTURE · S-400 CONTRACT AS THE NAMED HIGH-END ACQUISITION · INDO-RUSSIAN RIFLES PRIVATE LIMITED AT KORWA; LOCALISATION TO BE

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
COMPLEMENTARITY → India energy-deficient, Russia energy-surplus	INSTALLED BASE → Su-30MKI licensed production; BrahMos joint venture	AK-203 → Indo-Russian Rifles Private Limited at Korwa; localisation to be verified
UNIQUE SUPPLY → high-technology equipment including nuclear-powered submarines	2018 → S-400 contract as the named high-end acquisition	UNVERIFIED → S-400 delivery status and Russian-crude volumes without an official figure

CORE CLAIM

- COMPLEMENTARITY → India energy-deficient, Russia energy-surplus
- UNIQUE SUPPLY → high-technology equipment including nuclear-powered submarines

MECHANISM

- INSTALLED BASE → Su-30MKI licensed production; BrahMos joint venture
- 2018 → S-400 contract as the named high-end acquisition

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- AK-203 → Indo-Russian Rifles Private Limited at Korwa; localisation to be verified
- UNVERIFIED → S-400 delivery status and Russian-crude volumes without an official figure

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: UNVERIFIED → S-400 delivery status and Russian-crude volumes without an official figure.

05

STAGE 05 — INDIA-CHINA PROCESS ARCHITECTURE

INDIA-CHINA PROCESS ARCHITECTURE · 21 OCTOBER 2024 · PATROLLING ARRANGEMENTS ANNOUNCED; SPECIFIED AS DEPSANG AND DEMCHOK · 18 DECEMBER 2024 · TWENTY-THIRD SPECIAL REPRESENTATIVES ROUND, BEIJING · 19 AUGUST 2025 · TWENTY-FOURTH ROUND, NEW DELHI; EXPERT GROUP ON EARLY HARVEST · 31 AUGUST 2025

21 OCTOBER 2024 — patrolling arrangements announced; specified as Depsang and Demchok → 18 DECEMBER 2024: twenty-third Special Representatives round, Beijing → 19 AUGUST 2025: twenty-fourth round, New Delhi → Expert Group on early harvest delimitation → WMCC working group

CORE CLAIM

- 21 OCTOBER 2024 → patrolling arrangements announced; specified as Depsang and Demchok
- 18 DECEMBER 2024: twenty-third Special Representatives round, Beijing
- 19 AUGUST 2025: twenty-fourth round, New Delhi
- Expert Group on early harvest delimitation

MECHANISM

- WMCC working group
- General-Level Mechanisms in Eastern and Middle sectors
- 31 AUGUST 2025: leaders meet at Tianjin
- 27 MAY 2026: thirty-fifth WMCC, Beijing, prepares the next round

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- STATUS → process architecture, expressly not a boundary settlement
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Border claim, Line of Actual Control perception, agreed boundary,...

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Border claim, Line of Actual Control perception, agreed boundary,.

06

STAGE 06 — DESIGNATED BORDER-TRADE POINTS

DESIGNATED BORDER-TRADE POINTS · EXISTING DESIGNATED POINT PROVIDED FOR IN THE REOPENING ARRANGEMENT · SHIPKI LA · NATHU LA · AGREED AT THE TWENTY-FOURTH SPECIAL REPRESENTATIVES ROUND, 19 AUGUST · PROVISION FOR REOPENING TRADE IS NOT EVIDENCE OF RESUMED

LIPULEKH — existing designated point provided for in the reopening arrangement → SHIPKI LA — existing designated point provided for in the reopening arrangement → NATHU LA — existing designated point provided for in the reopening arrangement → SOURCE — agreed at the twenty-fourth Special Representatives round, 19 August 2025 → LIMIT — provision for reopening trade is not evidence of resumed trade volume

CORE CLAIM

- LIPULEKH → existing designated point provided for in the reopening arrangement
- SHIPKI LA → existing designated point provided for in the reopening arrangement

MECHANISM

- NATHU LA → existing designated point provided for in the reopening arrangement
- SOURCE → agreed at the twenty-fourth Special Representatives round, 19 August 2025

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- LIMIT → provision for reopening trade is not evidence of resumed trade volume
- LIPULEKH → existing designated point provided for in the reopening arrangement

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → provision for reopening trade is not evidence of resumed trade volume.

07

STAGE 07 — TARIFF CYCLE STRESS TEST

TARIFF CYCLE STRESS TEST · 7 AUGUST 2025 · 25 PER CENT INDIA-SPECIFIC RECIPROCAL DUTY, EXECUTIVE ORDER 14326 · 27 AUGUST 2025 · ADDITIONAL 25 PER CENT RUSSIAN-OIL-LINKED DUTY, EXECUTIVE ORDER 14329 · 4 AND 6 AUGUST 2025 · INDIA CALLS THE ACTION UNJUSTIFIED AND UNREASONABLE · 7 FEBRUARY 2026

7 AUGUST 2025 — 25 per cent India-specific reciprocal duty, Executive Order 14326 → 27 AUGUST 2025 — additional 25 per cent Russian-oil-linked duty, Executive Order 14329 → 4 AND 6 AUGUST 2025 — India calls the action unjustified and unreasonable → 7 FEBRUARY 2026 — additional duty removed, Executive Order 14384 → FEBRUARY 2026 — IEEPA additional duties ended by Executive Order 14389

CORE CLAIM

- 7 AUGUST 2025 — 25 per cent India-specific reciprocal duty, Executive Order 14326
- 27 AUGUST 2025 → additional 25 per cent Russian-oil-linked duty, Executive Order 14329
- 4 AND 6 AUGUST 2025 → India calls the action unjustified and unreasonable

MECHANISM

- 7 FEBRUARY 2026 → additional duty removed, Executive Order 14384
- FEBRUARY 2026 → IEEPA additional duties ended by Executive Order 14389
- 24 JULY 2026 → separate 10 per cent Section 301 duty on specified Indian goods

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- READING → partnership and coercive trade measures ran from the same partner at once

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: READING → partnership and coercive trade measures ran from the same partner at once.

08

STAGE 08 — JAPAN DIVERSIFICATION PILLAR

JAPAN DIVERSIFICATION PILLAR · ELEVATED TO A SPECIAL STRATEGIC AND GLOBAL PARTNERSHIP · 20 AUGUST 2024 · THIRD TWO-PLUS-TWO AGREES TO REVISE THE 2008 SECURITY DECLARATION · SEPTEMBER 2020 · RECIPROCAL PROVISION OF SUPPLIES AND SERVICES SIGNED; OPERATIONAL 2021 · SINCE 2017 · JICA COMMITMENTS EXCEEDING ONE TRILLION YEN FOR HIGH-SPEED RAIL

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
2014 → elevated to a Special Strategic and Global Partnership	SEPTEMBER 2020 → Reciprocal Provision of Supplies and Services signed; operational 2021	APRIL 2021 → Supply Chain Resilience Initiative with Australia and Japan
20 AUGUST 2024 → third two-plus-two agrees to revise the 2008 security declaration	SINCE 2017 → JICA commitments exceeding one trillion yen for high-speed rail	LIMIT → logistics access is not collective defence; matching is not relocated production

CORE CLAIM

- 2014 → elevated to a Special Strategic and Global Partnership
- 20 AUGUST 2024 → third two-plus-two agrees to revise the 2008 security declaration

MECHANISM

- SEPTEMBER 2020 → Reciprocal Provision of Supplies and Services signed; operational 2021
- SINCE 2017 → JICA commitments exceeding one trillion yen for high-speed rail

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- APRIL 2021 → Supply Chain Resilience Initiative with Australia and Japan
- LIMIT → logistics access is not collective defence; matching is not relocated production

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → logistics access is not collective defence; matching is not relocated production.

09

STAGE 09 — EUROPEAN UNION PILLAR AND LEGAL STATUS

EUROPEAN UNION PILLAR AND LEGAL STATUS · TRADE AND TECHNOLOGY COUNCIL FOR TECHNOLOGY, GREEN TRANSITION AND · 27 JANUARY 2026 · FREE TRADE AGREEMENT NEGOTIATIONS CONCLUDED · LEGAL REVIEW AND RATIFICATION REMAINED NECESSARY BEFORE ENTRY INTO · A CONCLUDED NEGOTIATION IS NEITHER SIGNATURE NOR ENTRY INTO · WIDER TECHNOLOGY, MARKET AND REGULATORY OPTIONS BEYOND US-CHINA COMPETITION

CHANNEL — Trade and Technology Council for technology, green transition and standards → 27 JANUARY 2026 — free trade agreement negotiations concluded → PENDING — legal review and ratification remained necessary before entry into force → CONSEQUENCE — a concluded negotiation is neither signature nor entry into force → GAIN — wider technology, market and regulatory options beyond US-China competition

CORE CLAIM

- CHANNEL → Trade and Technology Council for technology, green transition and standards
- 27 JANUARY 2026 → free trade agreement negotiations concluded

MECHANISM

- PENDING → legal review and ratification remained necessary before entry into force
- CONSEQUENCE → a concluded negotiation is neither signature nor entry into force

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- GAIN → wider technology, market and regulatory options beyond US-China competition
- CHANNEL → Trade and Technology Council for technology, green transition and standards

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: GAIN → wider technology, market and regulatory options beyond US-China competition.

10

STAGE 10 — UKRAINE ENGINE AND MINILATERAL BALANCING

UKRAINE ENGINE AND MINILATERAL BALANCING · DIALOGUE AND DIPLOMACY; SOVEREIGNTY AND TERRITORIAL INTEGRITY INVOKED · UN POSTURE · GENERALLY ABSTAINED ON POLARISING RESOLUTIONS; HUMANITARIAN ASSISTANCE SENT · ENERGY AND FERTILISER · DISCOUNTED SUPPLIES REDIRECTED TOWARD INDIA · SANCTIONS RISK, PAYMENT AND LOGISTICS FRICTION, UNILATERAL TARIFF PRESSURE · NON-TREATY QUAD AND I2U2 ADD CHANNELS AT A COORDINATION

PRINCIPLES — dialogue and diplomacy; sovereignty and territorial integrity invoked → UN POSTURE: generally abstained on polarising resolutions; humanitarian assistance sent → ENERGY AND FERTILISER: discounted supplies redirected toward India → EXPOSURE: sanctions risk, payment and logistics friction, unilateral tariff pressure → MINILATERAL: non-treaty Quad and I2U2 add channels at a coordination cost

CORE CLAIM

- PRINCIPLES → dialogue and diplomacy; sovereignty and territorial integrity invoked
- UN POSTURE: generally abstained on polarising resolutions; humanitarian assistance sent

MECHANISM

- ENERGY AND FERTILISER: discounted supplies redirected toward India
- EXPOSURE: sanctions risk, payment and logistics friction, unilateral tariff pressure

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- MINILATERAL: non-treaty Quad and I2U2 add channels at a coordination cost
- SPILLOVER → Black Sea disruption affected food, fertiliser, freight and energy markets

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SPILLOVER → Black Sea disruption affected food, fertiliser, freight and energy markets.

11

STAGE 11 — ANSWER SPINE FOR A MAJOR-POWER DEMAND

ANSWER SPINE FOR A MAJOR-POWER DEMAND · STATE THE STRUCTURAL DIFFERENCE BETWEEN THE CHINA, UNITED STATES · EVIDENCE EACH TRACK WITH ONE DATED INSTRUMENT AT ITS · PRICE THE TARIFF CYCLE AND THE TECHNOLOGY-ACCESS FRICTION AS · REFUSE THE REPLACEMENT NARRATIVE AND RELINK THE VERDICT TO · EVIDENCE LIMIT · DISTINGUISH ANNOUNCED INITIATIVE

OPEN — state the structural difference between the China, United States and Russia ties → BUILD — evidence each track with one dated instrument at its exact evidentiary level → TEST — price the tariff cycle and the technology-access friction as real, dated limits → CLOSE — refuse the replacement narrative and relink the verdict to strategic autonomy → EVIDENCE LIMIT: STATUS / LEVELS / IMPLEMENTATION: Distinguish announced initiative

CORE CLAIM

- OPEN → state the structural difference between the China, United States and Russia ties
- BUILD → evidence each track with one dated instrument at its exact evidentiary level

MECHANISM

- TEST → price the tariff cycle and the technology-access friction as real, dated limits
- CLOSE → refuse the replacement narrative and relink the verdict to strategic autonomy

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- EVIDENCE LIMIT: STATUS / LEVELS / IMPLEMENTATION: Distinguish announced initiative...
- OPEN → state the structural difference between the China, United States and Russia ties

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE → refuse the replacement narrative and relink the verdict to strategic autonomy.

E

EXTRA — SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · ICET (ANNOUNCED MAY 2022; INAUGURAL NSA-LEVEL MEETING 31 JANUARY · INDIA-US CLEAN-ENERGY SUPPLY-CHAIN COMMITMENTS (21 SEPTEMBER 2024) · TRUST AND COMPACT (13 FEBRUARY 2025) · THE CURRENT INDIA-US TECHNOLOGY · FRAMEWORK FOR THE US-INDIA MAJOR DEFENSE PARTNERSHIP (KUALA LUMPUR · THE 2025-26 US TARIFF CYCLE AS AN ARCHITECTURE STRESS · A 25%

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH	ADVANCED DEBATE	LEGACY / NUANCE
• ICET (announced May 2022; inaugural NSA-level meeting 31 January 2023;	• The 2025-26 US tariff cycle as an architecture stress test: a 25%	• Direct PYQ boundary case (2024 Q9): the supplied paper text reads
• India-US clean-energy supply-chain commitments (21 September 2024):	• India-Russia continuity architecture: the 23rd Annual Summit (New	• CAUTION: Boundary case — trade deficit with China as economic grievance layered
• TRUST and COMPACT (13 February 2025): the current India-US technology	• India-China border and dialogue architecture: the patrolling	• CAUTION: Boundary case — Russia-US simultaneous engagement: the continued
• Framework for the US-India Major Defense Partnership (Kuala Lumpur, 31	• CAUTION: Quad and I2U2 as minilateral supply-chain vehicles: these	• CAUTION: Boundary case — unresolved technology-access asymmetry with the US:

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels